

# George Douglas Papers annotated transcription

## *Volume II*

### *Folder 1 Correspondence and loan papers*

Version 1.0

September 2026

Prepared for Volney Douglas

For contribution to Abilene Christian University

Special Collections and Archives

Direct transcription with marked uncertainties and editorial notes. Original scans supplied by ACU; AI-assisted typescript offered for repository review.

This volume covers 96 source scan pages. The complete set covers six PDFs and 387 scan pages. Damaged passages remain partial or tentative where marked.

### **Volumes in this edition**

- I Guide and finding aid with sermon and church papers
- II Folder 1 Correspondence and loan papers
- III Folder 2 Correspondence and legal papers
- IV Folder 3 Correspondence and legal papers

# Reading this volume

## Preparation and review

Prepared for Volney Douglas with AI assistance in September 2026, from visual reading of the supplied scans. Each scan received an initial reading; selected doubtful passages received a focused second reading. The page inventory identifies the review level. This edition has not received an independent human transcription check or repository approval. It is offered for scholarly review and correction, and does not replace the source images.

## Wording and layout

Original wording, spelling, grammar, abbreviations and recoverable punctuation are retained. No silent expansion or modernization is intended. Handwritten capitalization, punctuation and word division sometimes require judgment. Superscripts are lowered to the baseline. Ordinary line wrapping is reflowed; verse lines, addresses and separate text blocks are distinguished. Underlining and decorative features are not systematically encoded. This is a direct reading transcript, not a facsimile or a fully diplomatic edition.

## Uncertainty notation

Double square brackets contain editorial intervention. `[[illegible]]` means writing could not be read; an unspecified gap does not imply a word count. Adjacent unreadable spans may be combined. A stated extent, such as `[[illegible: approximately 3 words]]`, is an estimate. `[[word?]]` gives a tentative reading, including tentative phrases. `[[lost: torn edge]]` records writing missing at a damaged edge; `[[obscured: fold]]` identifies an obstruction. Original single brackets remain as written. No missing wording is supplied solely to produce a fluent sentence.

## Corrections and separate blocks

`[[deleted: text]]` records readable canceled text; `[[deleted: illegible]]` records an unread cancellation. `[[inserted: text]]` records a significant insertion in its intended position. `[[margin]]` and `[/margin]]` enclose marginal writing. `[[postmark]]` and `[[postage]]` identify postal text. `[[blank]]`, `[[seal]]` and `[[sketch]]` identify useful non-textual features. A `[[separate block: description]]` marker introduces an independently positioned passage. Handwriting or cancellation may itself be uncertain.

## Source order and later descriptions

Entries follow the PDFs' scan order. Where the leaves appear out of sequence, the editorial note suggests a reading order without moving the entry. Later identifying slips are transcribed separately; their names, dates and attributions are not silently substituted for manuscript readings. Duplicate scans retain separate entries. Apparent contradictions are recorded rather than reconciled.

## References and corrections

A page ID such as 05-025 means source 05, PDF scan page 25, counting the cover as page 1. A block ID such as 05-025-P02 adds the second transcript paragraph or block. These are editorial locators; they are not manuscript page numbers. Suggested citation: George Douglas Papers annotated transcription,

version 1.0, 05-025-P02; corresponding source 05, scan page 25. For a correction, give that locator, the existing wording, a proposed reading, and the image or other evidence supporting it.

## **Repository credit**

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## Source 04

ACU CRS MS5 - 04 - Folder 1, Correspondence and Loan Papers.pdf

96 PDF scan pages including the repository cover.

SHA-256: 5c93172385acbe177e2cfb2f190f58fbd534ee5a468be3843ad6dc6ae91ed2bb

### Scan 001 04-001

Repository cover | Source 04, PDF page 1

04-001-P01 Abilene Christian University  
Digital Commons @ ACU

04-001-P02 George Douglas Papers  
Digitized Manuscripts, Personal Papers and Archival Records

04-001-P03 1939

04-001-P04 George Douglas Papers Folder 1 - Correspondence, Loan Papers

04-001-P05 Douglas

04-001-P06 Follow this and additional works at: [https://digitalcommons.acu.edu/george\\_douglas](https://digitalcommons.acu.edu/george_douglas)  
Part of the Christianity Commons, Genealogy Commons, Military History Commons, Social History Commons, and the United States History Commons

### Scan 002 04-002

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 2

04-002-P01 Orange Co Texas  
June 28th /64

04-002-P02 Cousin George Dear Sir

04-002-P03 having a chance of Sending you a note I take pleasure in informing you that I am in good health & fine spirits. Our Regt left Alexandria La Yesterday week for *[[illegible]]*. I was detailed to go down on Red River & join the Command at *[[Walkers?]]* Bend - but it has not passed I expect them Every *[[illegible]]* The Sabine laying up - I cant leave - Our field & *[[illegible]]* yet.

04-002-P04 All at home to Eliza & family - also *[[illegible]]* well on *[[illegible]]* furlough I suppose you have heard of the death of Uncle *[[Alfred?]]* he died on the 5th of June from a wound Recd on the 18th of May - The Gentleman awaits on me & *[[illegible]]* you a too bad *[[illegible]]*. Please write to me all the news immediately Let me know how you are all getting along I have been going to *[[illegible]]* - Wish I could come & see you but I could *[[illegible]]*.

04-002-P05 *[[illegible: closing]]*  
*[[J. H. Scott?]]*

**Editorial note.** The scan is upside down; read after rotation through 180 degrees. Fading affects many lines, especially the closing. The place after Alexandria and the signature need review. No destination is inferred from context.

**Scan 003 04-003**

Address panel | Source 04, PDF page 3

04-003-P01 George Douglas

Co C

[[illegible]] Regt

Sab Pass

04-003-P02 By Mr Richardson

"

**Editorial note.** The address block and carrier notation run at right angles. Read after rotation. The initial line of the regiment designation is faint.

**Scan 004 04-004**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 4

04-004-P01 Brushy Ellis County Texas

Friday Jan 29th 1864

04-004-P02 Mr George Douglas

Dear [[Bro?]] &amp; Cousin,

04-004-P03 By the above Caption You are informed of my Whereabouts After an absence of twenty odd months I arrived at [[illegible]] on 22d of the month Since which time I have mingled with the friends of the [[illegible]]. Truly I have had a pleasant time - The courteous manner in which I have been every where received and the kindness shown to me has been truly gratifying to me personally. I have just returned from Aunt Betties and concluded I would chat you a little while through the medium as a substitute, to an oral one.

04-004-P04 I wrote to you last Sept but have never learned the destination of my letter - [[deleted: illegible]] you did not return it, [[deleted: illegible]] if you did I did not reply [[illegible]] this one will not prove offensive to you. Since Feb 1st - I have been on detached Service the greater portion of the time - Last Feb was sent to the Ouachita river Country to gather forage for the Command. Was engaged in this business two months. [[illegible]] of my [[Solitariness?]] passed more pleasantly the first month excepted than [[illegible]] to you all "bibs", and as a matter of course, [[illegible]] pleased more than the ladies in the prettiest Looks - Smiles & kindest [[illegible]] and when the pot boiled the strongest and being not entirely [[illegible]] of the influence of the gentle fair, on some occasions I [[illegible]] their claims. And was almost persuaded (I like to have said taken unawares) [[illegible]] the "equal" in [[gentility?]] & [[illegible]] of the Young ladies of my former [[illegible]] - The brindle of my acquaintances [[illegible]] shirts [[illegible]] as they seem to have especial claims of Superiority [[illegible]].

04-004-P05 But Enough on this subject as it is hardly entitled to a place in these times of strife & Confusion - Whilst the all absorbing all engrossing theme is War War - its stern realities & consequences Which at present our Country has begun to feel the Weight of considerably.

**Editorial note.** Friday Jan 29th 1864 is the reading of the heading. Extensive dark photocopy interference obscures words; the social comparison in the lower half particularly needs review. The text continues in the upper upright block of scan page 5.

## Scan 005 04-005

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 5

04-005-P01 Well, Something of our Movements; In the Last part of the fall a portion of our Regt was sent out to assist the Louisianians in getting

04-005-P02 *[[separate block]]*

*[[Joda?]]* remembers you has a very loving hand & I am sure would like to *[[illegible]]* with you - So if you wish to *[[illegible]]* you & her *[[illegible]]* agree upon the condition of getting *[[illegible]]* - I must say *[[illegible]]* *[[partly?]]* hard *[[illegible]]* perhaps you can *[[illegible]]*. Cousin Lizzie carries *[[illegible]]* with her & now sits near me *[[perusing?]]* a Letter Which purports to have come from *[[illegible]]* the *[[illegible]]*.

04-005-P03 Well George I could see a young lady Who I think is the *[[illegible]]* in my quarters *[[illegible]]* during the *[[illegible]]* took *[[illegible]]* to speak in glowing terms of you. Which *[[illegible]]* led *[[illegible]]* of meaning *[[deleted: illegible]]* that I am warranted in saying *[[illegible]]* have no fears, but that all will be well *[[illegible]]* any *[[adherers?]]*.

04-005-P04 Well George - As *[[illegible]]* of *[[illegible]]* and *[[illegible]]* - I will tell you that *[[deleted: illegible]]* the effect of General Remarks Since my arrival - If there is any thing in Reports I have been married to two *[[illegible]]* in the Country & Started to get a License in the 3d instance. I hope to a *[[illegible]]* that I should be charged with such good things & no thanks *[[illegible]]*. *[[illegible]]* I made out to tell one *[[illegible]]* the report was true - but She Curled her lip & replied "Indeed" So I was astonished of my sins - I was not aware of being so popular - perhaps its the *[[illegible]]* the bracing Air dont you think -

04-005-P05 By the way Since I *[[illegible]]* many of the Staff the officers of Braggs Army have *[[illegible]]* a considerable *[[illegible]]* of attention to *[[illegible]]* - I expect to hear of the *[[illegible]]* of the Ladies *[[illegible]]* - If so I think it would be a damn reason to raise a Regt & wish you to be my Chf of Staff What think you of the *[[illegible]]*.

04-005-P06 A Corporals guard came my *[[illegible]]* *[[Sunday?]]* *[[illegible]]* I think *[[illegible]]* I could have made up a Company. I have used the *[[illegible]]* & Mollie & they think the whole arrangement a fine one - I promised my influence upon condition they *[[illegible]]* be *[[illegible]]* - I must conclude as my thought is fleeting & *[[illegible]]* *[[illegible: approximately one line]]*. *[[illegible]]* them less than a bushel with a *[[illegible]]* that you distribute between *[[illegible]]* & Quincy being Careful to return an ample amount *[[illegible]]* Address me at Hempstead Tex Co G Browns Regt. Your Cousin Henry.

04-005-P07 *[[margin]]*

Sat 30th I am on Lizzie *[[Suite?]]* & I expect to go to Lancaster tomorrow to hear Mr *[[Brown?]]* *[[illegible]]*. If the weather is favorable & *[[illegible]]* *[[opportunity?]]* for *[[illegible]]* I fear it will not be *[[illegible]]*. *[[illegible]]* and *[[illegible]]* Henry *[[/margin]]*

**Editorial note.** The top upright lines continue scan page 4. The large lower block contains the letter conclusion; the inverted strip across the top is a later addition. These blocks are kept separate. Heavy photocopy interference leaves substantial gaps and tentative readings.

**Scan 006 04-006**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 6

04-006-P01 of another year. As the war promises very little at present & *[[illegible]]*

04-006-P02 *[[illegible]]* our country. While *[[illegible]]* most of our Soldiers lie down *[[illegible]]* might we confront a Large army. *[[illegible]]* foes Scattered as they are *[[illegible]]* of the disaffection in *[[illegible]]* Battalions — Nothing is more *[[illegible]]* a Soldier than to be oppressed & tyrannized over — In this respect *[[illegible]]* off Well. We have enjoyed privileges that are *[[illegible]]* Soldiers *[[illegible]]* Army. Monotonous time indeed would be written *[[illegible]]* but I reckon a person can habituate himself to most any thing as we are creatures of habit.

04-006-P03 The Old Folks & John are enjoying good health. In the main I perceive no great change in them *[[illegible]]* developing a little more anxiety. The Young *[[illegible]]* home *[[illegible]]* I *[[would?]]* have *[[illegible]]* engaged Sister E *[[illegible]]* her *[[illegible]]* to *[[illegible]]* this Letter *[[illegible]]* but She will not agree to do it. The Young ladies are looking very Well generally. There are too many of them to Speak of them individually. I have attended Liberty 3 Sundays Since my arrival & Wish you Could have been with me to have taken a charge, as I could not make *[[illegible]]* of myself consequently had to manifest partiality. I go most *[[illegible]]* Miss *[[illegible]]* Pet & *[[McChapel?]]* Staid with us *[[illegible]]* months *[[illegible]]* & Miss *[[illegible]]* whom I am home with *[[illegible]]* suffice it to say She *[[illegible]]* I visited *[[illegible]]* the Colony. Was at Mrs G's last evening. Miss Ella & Laura Were there. The Conversation was of a party at McFaddens last night. I told them I would *[[illegible]]* go with them to the Elysian *[[Fields?]]* as I cared nothing for the party. *[[illegible]]*

04-006-P04 *[[illegible]]* that is all. — I hope *[[illegible]]*

04-006-P05 I tell you the time of day which is 2 PM. *[[illegible]]*

04-006-P06 *[[margin]]*

*[[illegible]]*

*[[/margin]]*

**Editorial note.** Continuation of the Henry Douglas letter on scans 4–7. The heavy reversed writing visible through the paper cannot always be separated from the face text. Several lines and marginal writing remain unread. The sequence of the letter appears to continue here from scan 7; scan order is retained for reference.

**Scan 007 04-007**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 7

04-007-P01 into the Service, Where it Seems we all arrive at the Same, now in October Col Burleson having become famous as a “Rosin Heel” catcher was Sent to this State on the Same business, Where we were mortified *[[illegible]]* Texas Contained quite a *[[illegible]]* of the above Character. I joined the Command in Hopkins County the Last of Nov & Soon after was detailed to take Some prisoners to Tyler — was then detailed to deliver them at Shreveport — Was there ordered to take Some *[[illegible]]* Guns to Bonham. This *[[illegible]]* to me *[[illegible]]* thinking the *[[illegible]]* would not admit *[[illegible]]* home — we Concluded to go on to Bonham. Our Co was permitted to Spend the “Holidays” in this County & Staid at home Some 15 days — then reported at Crockett & from there has gone to San Augustine. I will prefeere not to be *[[illegible]]* at this business As it is by no means agreeable to my feelings. Our Brigade is ordered to be at Hempstead Tex by the 10th of Feb — It moves by Way of Shreveport & I hope our detachment will be permitted to *[[illegible]]* it on the Way.

04-007-P02 I leave Monday for the Command. I first recd a 20 days furlough before its expiration was detailed to transact some business here. Those *[[illegible]]* to the Co are given Every 2 mo — I have not drawn a *[[illegible]]* leave yet. Jim Lowder of Ross' Regt is home on furlough. The Squad he came With brought Some Arms across the “Trans*[[illegible]]*” *[[illegible]]* 6 millions in Confed. Money. He reports the Miss Army — Well supplied & buoyant in Spirits. We have not heard from *[[illegible]]* & James Since the middle of Oct. James was *[[illegible]]* Wounded *[[illegible]]* in the Chickamauga Battle. I am very anxious to know how They came off at the Chattanooga fight. Capt Bledsoe left Lancaster a few days Since to resume the Command of his Company — which will be very gratifying to them as they were not pleased With the Capt put over them at the instigation of *[[illegible]]* Command. The last *[[illegible]]* of the militia has been called out too & are now enroute for Galveston All (too) were mustered into the Service and those unable to go now have received furloughs from one to Six months in length

**Editorial note.** Continuation of the Henry Douglas letter on scans 4–7. Reversed show-through and dark folds obscure some words. The first line appears to continue the upper text block of scan 5; the final sentence continues on scan 6.

## Scan 008 04-008

Fragments | Source 04, PDF page 8

04-008-P01 *[[separate block: larger fragment]]*

04-008-P02 Dear Cousin — I Spent the Evening *[[lost: edge]]*  
I took a peep at your “Shadow” which looked *[[lost: edge]]*  
*[[illegible]]* — Read Some poetical Contributions *[[lost: edge]]*  
*[[illegible]]* — *[[illegible]]* tis fruitful imagination *[[lost: edge]]*

04-008-P03 *[[separate block: smaller fragment, first orientation]]*

04-008-P04 Col Patton has *[[lost: edge]]*  
a force of 2500 *[[lost: edge]]*  
*[[illegible]]* the siege *[[lost: edge]]*  
*[[illegible]]* the mouth of *[[lost: edge]]*  
*[[illegible]]* a certain amount of *[[lost: edge]]*

04-008-P05 *[[separate block: smaller fragment, opposite orientation]]*

04-008-P06 *[[lost: edge]]* from Charleston *[[illegible]]*  
*[[lost: edge]]* at *[[illegible]]* now  
*[[lost: edge]]* blockade *[[illegible]]*

**Editorial note.** Two small fragments are reproduced on the scan; each also carries text in an opposing orientation. Line endings are retained here because substantial text is missing at the edges. The relationship of the fragments is uncertain.

## Scan 009 04-009

Fragments | Source 04, PDF page 9

04-009-P01 *[[separate block: longer fragment, first orientation]]*

04-009-P02 *[[lost: edge]]* the Vicksburg affair  
*[[lost: edge]]* *[[illegible]]* a certain *[[illegible]]* “Your Last” You have been deprived  
of *[[illegible]]* but that is not *[[illegible]]* at least act *[[illegible]]*  
my faint *[[illegible]]* pray God to give *[[illegible]]*  
*[[illegible]]* these few *[[illegible]]* friends *[[illegible]]*

04-009-P03 *[[separate block: longer fragment, opposite orientation]]*

04-009-P04 *[[lost: edge]]* has been Considerable Stirring & quibbling on  
*[[lost: edge]]* they all have to go if the Emergency is Such *[[lost: edge]]*  
*[[lost: edge]]* *[[illegible]]* *[[Yankee?]]* is certain *[[lost: edge]]*

04-009-P05 *[[separate block: smaller fragment]]*

04-009-P06 *[[illegible]]*  
very friendly  
*[[illegible]]* friend *[[lost: edge]]*  
*[[illegible]]* the *[[lost: edge]]*

**Editorial note.** Two fragments with broken text. Text on the longer fragment is written in opposing orientations. Dark reproduction obscures most of the smaller fragment. Text has not been supplied from another letter.

## Scan 010 04-010

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 10

04-010-P01 Camp *[[Yavely?]]* Texas  
March 13/65 —

04-010-P02 Cousin George

04-010-P03 Dear Sir

04-010-P04 I acknowledge your Kind Letter of the 1st inst which inspired many pleasant emotions  
especially the part Relating to our association in years gone by — But while enjoying those things one is  
Drawn in Retrospection and reflecting upon the return of a Long absent Brother all joy has been turned  
into sadness by the Intelligence of the Death of your Sister. All had been fill with sanguine emotions of  
gladness and joyous are the recollections of by gone times. Cousin George In this dark hour of  
bereavement you have my Sympathies. My tongue can give vent to but little yet I sincerely have ever  
been Sorry Although the fleeting of Life are overtaken by the Cold relentless Clay are moved to an  
*[[illegible]]* of mortality thro our own frailness then *[[illegible]]* our comfort *[[illegible]]* duty and  
happiness

**Editorial note.** Camp name and some wording in the latter part of the paragraph are uncertain in the dark scan. The date reads March 13/65. Continues on scan 11.

## Scan 011 04-011

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 11

04-011-P01 We are all well here and Continue to have Agreeable times We Came to this place the 5th of  
March and will more *[[illegible]]* very likely be to the Brazos County. I suppose the forage in this section  
will become exhausted in Ten days or less when *[[Lafayette?]]* arrival was very Unexpected to me. I had

great fears that he had not survived The Tenn Campaign. Through him *[[illegible]]* I Recd a Letter from Brother James which I enclose to you.

04-011-P02 Lafayette is desirous of a transfer to this Department. Mat Brawner of this Co desires To be transferred to *[[Saffold's?]]* Command & has *[[illegible]]* Capt *[[Wad?]]* on the subject — The Capt Will make an Effort to have it arranged. Nothing save an immediate peace is more heartily wished by me.

04-011-P03 I am looking for Fayette with Sam'l *[[Rea?]]* in a few days. I have lately heard from Aunt *[[Matten?]]* all here was quite well. Write & Address me at Hempstead which is Corps headquarters.

04-011-P04 Kind Regards to Warren & John Your Cousin Henry

**Editorial note.** Continuation of scan 10. Several personal names and a unit name remain tentative; the manuscript is retained without expanding initials or abbreviations.

## Scan 012 04-012

Verse | Source 04, PDF page 12

04-012-P01 The River of death

04-012-P02 Beautiful world! I've trusted long  
To your gilded show, your Syren Song;  
I thought the joys you gave would last  
But one by one they have hurried past;  
Till now the last you could give has flown,  
And I stand by the River, Alone! Alone!

04-012-P03 I was merry once, and to music sweet  
Kept tinkling time with dancing feet;  
I crowned my hair with roses red,  
But the lute is shatter'd, the roses dead;  
Music and blossoms are long since gone,  
And I stand by the River, Alone! Alone!

04-012-P04 And once I loved; 'twas a dream of bliss,  
Could earth give more to her child than this?  
Rapture so great it was almost pain,  
A girdle of flowers with a silken chain;  
But love like a vision of night has flown,  
And I stand by the River, Alone! Alone!

**Editorial note.** Manuscript copy of a poem. The title and verse lineation are retained. Continues on scan 13.

## Scan 013 04-013

Verse and letter | Source 04, PDF page 13

04-013-P01 Then madly I quaffed the cup of fame,  
And smiled when thousands lisp'd my name,  
My brow was bound with a wreath of bay,  
But it faded quickly and drooped away,

Leaf after leaf until all are gone,  
And I stand by the River Alone! Alone!

04-013-P02 And what have I done O Christ! for thee?  
Drear the visions my dim eyes see!  
Have I given a cup of water cold  
To a single Lamb in Thy precious fold?  
Time for working is past and gone,  
And I stand by the River Alone! Alone!

04-013-P03 O Christ! have mercy! The waters wild  
Are sweeping away Thy erring child;  
Wilt Thou not listen? O, take my hand,  
And guide me through to a distant land;  
All that I trusted on earth has flown,  
Must I sink in the River, Alone! Alone!

04-013-P04 The River! The River! tis dark and wide,  
But I see a light on the other Side!  
My heart no longer is faint with fear,  
For Heaven has help; my God is near!  
With joyous footsteps I hasten on  
No more in the River, Alone! Alone!

04-013-P05 *[[separate block: accompanying letter]]*

04-013-P06 Bloomsdale July 6th/65

04-013-P07 Cousin Lizzie

04-013-P08 As you thought the first of the foregoing lines that I repeated the night of the 4th were beautiful — To gratify a Scribbling inclination, I have drawn a Copy for you — believing you will *[[illegible]]* folly. I think them very beautiful — and this Express doubtless the position of every persons decease.

04-013-P09 Your Cousin  
James

04-013-P10 To Lizzie

**Editorial note.** Two manuscript panels on one scan, read down the left panel and then down the right. The last stanza is followed by the dated letter. The closing sentence and a word before “folly” remain uncertain.

## Scan 014 04-014

Endorsement | Source 04, PDF page 14

04-014-P01 Ballad  
“The River of Death”  
Written for Lizzie

**Editorial note.** Outer or title panel associated with the poem on scans 12–13. Most of the page is blank.

## Scan 015 04-015

Address fragment | Source 04, PDF page 15

04-015-P01 *[[illegible]]* Prairie *[[illegible]]* Apr 10 *[[lost: edge]]*

Mr Henry Seale  
Nashville Milam  
Texas

**Editorial note.** Torn fragment. The name appears to read Henry Seale; the beginning of the first line is damaged.

## Scan 016 04-016

Address fragment | Source 04, PDF page 16

04-016-P01 Nashville Texas Ap*[[lost: edge]]*

Miss Lizzy Douglas  
Redoak Po  
Texas

**Editorial note.** Torn address fragment. A possible postal abbreviation is retained as written; the date is incomplete.

## Scan 017 04-017

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 17

04-017-P01 *[[Yellow?]]* Branch *[[illegible]]*

Sept 18th 1863

04-017-P02 Cousin George. I have written Several times to you but Silence has been the result. My uncertain Whereabouts perhaps have been the Cause — for I cannot think you so ungenerous as not to have Written to me Since Sept last year. I have thought my letters of last Spring may have Contained something not acceptable — if so I cannot conceive what it was — for if you are like the majority of Soldiers — your Feelings could hardly be ruffled — I will try you another Effort and if Silence is the response I may know Something is wrong in *[[Denmark?]]*, & will call off my hounds. But as I am floating in rather a dull atmosphere I will not promise to be very interesting but trust I may for a while relieve you of the monotony of the Camps.

04-017-P03 I am home on a detail after Clothing for our Co. having reached Sat Evening. I find things moving on in this vicinity about like they did before the War began save the absence of Young men. Plenty Seems Smiling at every door — and were it not for absent ones I believe the people here would be happy. *[[illegible]]* quite warm weathering Carried on in North Carolina. As yet I have visited but Little. I have visited Waxahachie twice — a very important case being under Consideration in the Court — To wit; The murder of a Mrs Claunch by her Daughter — The case has not yet been decided but from the evidence I have heard believe she will come clear — but not in the Eyes of the people — as innocent of the offence. From Waxa on Monday I went to Red Oak Camp Ground — Camp meeting being on hand — and have remained till Tuesday — The meeting not so largely attended as in former years — Especially by the Sterner Sex — but there has been no discount on the other Side. The eating part received marked attention on my part. I indulge freely in those Substantials that keep Soul & body together — but did not Labor very hard to make myself agreeable — or to create a Contagious Sometimes

Called a “palpitation of the heart” — My observation teaches me That the germs of this malady are in an *[[illegible]]* State and only need Sunshine to bring them to bloom, Expand & Captivate —

04-017-P04 They had Shouting times that night — Some things done rather disorders — Some Singular movements. Amongst them was a Soldier friend — who yielded to the Solicitation of an Old Gentleman who has a Daughter that has *[[illegible]]* Claims upon him — I think the meeting is Still in operation — If Shoutings are an indication of Godliness — This is Certainly the most Christian people in the range of my knowledge. Possibly this may be attributable to the fact of the abundance of Preachers — who Claim exemption by reason of their vocation and fearing if they do not all Preach they will have to Shoulder their musket & Battle Some

**Editorial note.** Letter in a small, closely written hand with a fold and scattered reproduction damage. The first word of the place-name and several clauses remain uncertain. Continues on scan 18.

## Scan 018 04-018

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 18

04-018-P01 I will now tell you Something of the operations of our Command. In June it was ordered West & have just returned to about where we! The *[[illegible]]* was Countermanded & it with another *[[illegible]]* returned to the vicinity of *[[illegible]]* Remained in the Same about a month recruiting our horses. About The 1st of Aug. We moved to the Miss. Valley near Natchez — remained there a Couple of Weeks & then were ordered to Our former field (Ark). On the 31st of Aug the Brigade Started on their way rejoicing. We had Seen the Elephant in La & the Boys were willing to go any where. They will doubtless See Some other large Animal in Ark for they will have to ride it as they Left it. *[[deleted: illegible]]* The Division will be home before there — and they will have a tough time of it with Genl Steele. Majors' Div is also gone to take the *[[illegible]]* of Walker's *[[illegible]]* — Had taken up line of march for *[[illegible]]* & it was believed they would follow also — So now you may listen to hear of Stirring times this fall.

04-018-P02 Whilst Scouting on the Miss Our Squad turned over about 30 fine Horses their arms &c to the Yankee Sent *[[illegible]]* of them went down to New Orleans to get some Crackers. The others made their Escape Swimming & hiding in the *[[weeds?]]*. They were Completely Surprised at 3 oclk AM on the 28 of Aug — and a great Wonder all did not get *[[killed?]]*. Capt *[[Vardeman?]]* again Got into *[[illegible]]* Some Candy — He & the dismounted men are now at home *[[illegible]]* the election — I was not in the Regt yet & Some *[[illegible]]* of my mess but *[[illegible]]* had not come out on *[[illegible]]*. Bob got to Camps the day before I left — I had had chills for a month in the Summer was Sick last Evening & Expect them returning — Jeffie was down last week.

04-018-P03 We Learn Lizzie spent Sunday with you & she Returned to John on Monday. *[[Laura?]]* Spent last night here. Mother has had a very Sick Spell is getting over it. Had a fine Rain day before yesterday. *[[Br?]]* Sam Austin Called in today Returning from the meeting — The same is Still going on *[[illegible]]* the Camp but has been dispersed with only 7 professions So far — We recently Recd a Letter from Lafayette of *[[date?]]* 1st of Aug. Their Brigade had a heavy fight on the 22nd of July — their Regt went into Battle with 320 & Came out with about 80 — James who was in the *[[illegible]]* had a narrow Escape *[[illegible]]* All are Stout & healthy — They are *[[illegible]]* in high hopes of Early End of the War. I hope their *[[illegible]]* may be realized.

04-018-P04 *[[margin]]*

Since *[[illegible]]* — Those of their Co that was not killed had to Surrender & while They were Stacking

arms Hage *[[illegible]]* through *[[illegible]]* & Clem *[[illegible]]* was found at hind *[[illegible]]* My paper is full — I hope to hear from you before I leave for the army — Yours Truly

H D

*[[/margin]]*

**Editorial note.** Continuation of scan 17. The crowded lower lines and right margin are particularly difficult. Their sequence is provisional. Canceled text near the center is marked, and uncertain names and numerical readings should be checked against the scan.

## Scan 019 04-019

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 19

04-019-P01 Cold Springs Texas

Sept 19th /63

04-019-P02 Mr George Douglas

04-019-P03 Dear cousin

04-019-P04 Perhaps you will think strange of receiving a letter from me as you have in all probability forgotten your old hunting companion and school mate it has been A long time since we used to meet down on old Brushy and give the old gobblers a round. and I fear it will be a longer one Still before we can have that blessed privilege again. nearly Four years have pass Since I Saw you and I imagined that you are the Same old george you used to be. I have not changed in the least, only from the big to the bigger. I weigh 175 pounds and the largest Devil in co. (F.) I was ordered to report to the Brigade Quarter *[[Mr?]]* for fatigue duty this morning. got half way turned round and came back and now looking for the guard to arrest me and if they do I will lye out of it Some how.

04-019-P05 We are having A very pleasant time at this camp duty easy Drill Four evry day except Sundays *[[as wet foots?]]* we also have a chain guard around our camp wont let a fellow out with his Saddle. you ought to See the boys riding all over the Country bare back There is a big meeting going on in camp. There was about forty mourners last night. They haven't got me yet but I dont know how Soon they will for evry time the old fellow preaches Scare *[[there?]]* is A *[[frog?]]* in my throat as big as your fist

**Editorial note.** Letter continues on scan 20. Original informal spelling is retained. “as wet foots” and the wording before “is A” are difficult and may warrant revision.

## Scan 020 04-020

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 20

04-020-P01 I have not heard from my Brothers East of the miss for Two or three months I fear they are having A hard time of it

04-020-P02 I will bring this badly composed letter to a close give my respects to all of My friends

04-020-P03 As Ever Your Cousin

R D G

04-020-P04 P S write to me and give me all of the news and tell me how you like the war and when you think it will close

04-020-P05 Bob

**Editorial note.** Continuation and closing of scan 19. Signature initials appear to read R D G; the postscript is signed Bob.

## Scan 021 04-021

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 21

04-021-P01 Tupelo Mississippi Jan 25th/65

04-021-P02 Dear Brother

04-021-P03 As Brother Lafayette will Start home in a few days on furlough I will write you a few lines to let you know how I am getting along I was painfully wounded on the 22nd of July while Charging the enemys works The ball Struck me on the the left wrist and passed throw my hand my wrist Bones was badly fractured also the Bone of the middle finger I have Suffered a great deal with it about the middle of August I took the fever and for too months and for two months I were hardly able to get off of my bunk with out assistance — I Received 60 days furlough in October to go to mobile to See our relatives — When I arrived at Demopolis my hand was paining me very much and I was very unwell So I Concluded to Stop a few days untill I could get better I Stopped with an old Lady By the name of Brassfield Thair I had all the attention a confederate Soldier Could wish for. By the *[[time?]]* I was able to go on I had Concluded *[[to spend?]]* my furlong in that neighborhood & go to Mobile

**Editorial note.** The repeated “the” and repeated “for ... months” are in the manuscript and are retained. The last two lines are crowded and partially obscured. Continues on scan 22.

## Scan 022 04-022

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 22

04-022-P01 Some other time. I spent the time very pleasantly & only Regreted that I Couldent Stay longer I Shall never forget the kind people of Ala.

04-022-P02 At the expiration of my furlough I Started to the Command. But learning that I Couldent get to it. I turned my course and went to Columbus Miss. with the intention of getting my furlough extended and go on to Mobile. Before I Could get off from that place the Federals Destroyed the R Road So that I Could not get thair So I went in to the Hospital and remained thair untill a few days ago.

04-022-P03 My hand is not well yet. it has healed up on both Sides untill the Sear is the Size of a pea and it not heal any more it is running all the time The Doctors Say that is Caused by deceased Bone or by Some pieces of Bone that aught to have been removed My wrist will be entirely Stiff I think I will have the use of all of my fingers except the middle one.

04-022-P04 I Returned to the Command last week found the Boys all in good health Thair is very few of our Brigade left only about 4 hundred out of five Regiments

**Editorial note.** Continuation of scan 21. “deceased Bone” is retained as the writer appears to have written it; no medical correction is substituted.

## Scan 023 04-023

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 23

04-023-P01 *[[separate block: repeated portion of scan 21]]*

04-023-P02 Tupelo Mississippi Jan 25th/65

Dear Brother

As Brother Lafayette will Start  
home in a few days on furl[[lost: reproduced portion ends]]

04-023-P03 [[separate block: continuation]]

04-023-P04 Thair is only four of old Co "I" left that is able for duty. one to evry 7 is furloughed to go to Texas Brother Lafayette gets a 75 days furlough to go home I am glad that he gets to go and I would like to accompany him very much. But that I Cannot do honorably and I would not go home other wise.

04-023-P05 I am in hopes you will get to See Lafayette he can tell you all the news I would like to go home very much I tried to get [[deleted: illegible]] a furlough But failed. I Shall try and get on the Retired list as I am not able for field Service if I Should Succeed I think I will get home by next fall. If I get retired I would only Remain at home for 3 months I dont think I would go home to Stay as long as [[any?]] Stays in this army as we have been to gether all the time I think I aught to Stay with him Should he get Sick or wounded I would be here to help

**Editorial note.** The top of the scan repeats the heading and opening of scan 21. The main body continues scan 22. The word before "Stays" and portions of the crowded bottom line are uncertain.

## Scan 024 04-024

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 24

04-024-P01 [[separate block: repeated portion of scan 22]]

04-024-P02 Some other time. I spent the time very pleasantly & only Regreted that I Couldnt Stay longer I Shall never forget the kind people of Ala.

At the expiration of my furlough I Started [[lost: reproduced portion ends]]

04-024-P03 [[separate block: continuation and closing]]

04-024-P04 Lafayette has just Returned from the [[illegible]] Texas Squire gets a furlough they intended going to gether But Squire will not get off for a few days and Lafayette wants to Start to morrow so they will hardly go to gether. I will go with Lafayette as far as Meridian. I have not heard from our cousins (the Jetton boys) lately Jeppe is in prison Billy & Charly were well when last heard from. The Six Texas Boys were all well when last heard from. It is very Cold and I am Smoked nearly to death So I will Close for the present you will excuse hurty and badly written letter I will try and do better in the future Remember my Compliments to all the Boys and except of my Best wishes for your Selves. write often and I will do the Same hoping that we may Soon all meet again. I Remain as ever your true Brother  
James [[illegible]]

**Editorial note.** The top strip repeats part of scan 22. The remaining text concludes the letter. The surname or initials after James cannot be read confidently.

## Scan 025 04-025

Envelope | Source 04, PDF page 25

04-025-P01 Geo' Douglas —  
Red Oak Texas

04-025-P02 Zella Douglas —  
1715 — Grand Avenue —  
North Fort Worth —  
Texas.

04-025-P03 *[[postmark]]*  
RED OAK  
AUG  
*[[illegible]]*  
TEXAS  
*[/postmark]]*

04-025-P04 *[[postage]]*  
UNITED STATES  
TWO CENTS  
*[/postage]]*

**Editorial note.** Envelope read after rotation. The day and year of the postmark are not recoverable in this reproduction.

## Scan 026 04-026

Envelope annotation | Source 04, PDF page 26

04-026-P01 Met today Anna Conger now Mrs Smithson  
Eva's old playmate at Ferris

**Editorial note.** Handwritten note on the reverse of the envelope on scan 25.

## Scan 027 04-027

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 27

04-027-P01 Monday Morning.

04-027-P02 Dear Zella,

04-027-P03 Of course you would like to know of the meeting. While there has been no further additions, yesterday was a “big” day. According to announcement there was dinner on the ground. And such another dinner. About the finest ever spread at Sylvana. Among visitors present was White Stirman and *[[deleted: illegible]]* wife, (who sends her love to you) and Nellie Russell. They left after preaching last night for Ennis, White and family going to move right away to Marlin, where White has a job of running a “Watkins” Medicine wagon.

04-027-P04 From Oak Cliff were three carloads of people, Jeff Barclay among the number who kindly remembered you, the wife of J. C. Estes, the preacher, Bro. Stevens, mother wife and sister, Bro. Melton and family and Bro. Holsenback, and wife.

**Editorial note.** Continuation on scan 28. Personal names are transcribed as read; no attempt has been made to identify these visitors from outside records.

**Scan 028 04-028**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 28

04-028-P01 These enjoyed themselves finely, and were profuse in their invitations for me to visit them when in Dallas.

04-028-P02 Mrs. Dr. Mitchell and family, and Bro. Dunn's family were out from Waxahachie. These comprise the major part of the visitors who took dinner. After dinner Mrs Howard and family came in and remained until after night preaching. She was showered with attentions by all who knew her while she was with us, and last Cliff Stanford came much to the delight of his many friends.

04-028-P03 The meeting may close tonight, and maybe tomorrow night. Bro. Dunn being something of a revivalist is blue over his work here, he is disappointed.

04-028-P04 No change to report in Lucile's condition but I expect to finish this letter at Red Oak this evening; and will give latest dates.

04-028-P05 Larkin is much worse; the disease taking a malignant form day before yesterday. I will hear from him this morning. All company has been forbidden. The prospect is most serious.

**Editorial note.** Continuation of scan 27.

**Scan 029 04-029**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 29

04-029-P01 We will have to hedge on expenses. The Ellis Co. cotton crop is a failure today the eleventh of August. The worms have completely destroyed all the bolls and squares, and blooms are scarcer than I ever saw — if anything is made it has to be made in the future, there is nothing now. Worms are of all sizes and this argues that they will be with us some time yet.

04-029-P02 I hope you will continue to do well, get some weight and strength and hold both. I am feeling fine, batching must agree with me; but I am not stuck on it.

04-029-P03 Am getting from two to eight eggs per day.

04-029-P04 At Kate's. I found Lucile not so well as last Sunday — She seems quite unwell, suffering considerably. Kate says: "Her stomach has gone back on her." Poor Child, she looks badly. Larkin is about the same as *[[illegible]]* (Saturday) If he has strength to stand it he may pull through all right.

**Editorial note.** Continuation of scan 28. The pencil postscript is much fainter than the ink text. One word or phrase after "same as" remains unread.

**Scan 030 04-030**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 30

04-030-P01 Sermon to the Church to day —

Ila Duncan and Mayfaire made the confession and will be baptized this evening — meeting will close tomorrow night.

04-030-P02 Came up today and had a real civilized dinner with *[[Bros?]]* Duncan. I dont see why all women can't cook. Its so much nicer —

04-030-P03 Jesse Ligon and family have returned to Red Oak, bag and baggage. I am glad they have come back as Jess is the best Ligon of the whole bunch — Did I tell you that the old wooden center of Red Oak burned out from brick to brick? Well the old rat traps are gone. Some loss heavily —

04-030-P04 This covers the ground to date —  
Affectionately G. D.

04-030-P05 Do the best you can for yourself while you are there. Dont bother about me.  
My peach preserves were highly praised

04-030-P06 *[[margin]]*  
some of everything is made it has to be *[[lost: reproduced line ends]]*  
*[[/margin]]*

**Editorial note.** Closing continuation of scans 27–29. The inverted line at the foot appears to be an incidental partial reproduction rather than part of the closing postscript; it is recorded separately. The reading “Bros” and some pencil words should be checked against the scan.

### Scan 031 04-031

Envelope | Source 04, PDF page 31

04-031-P01 Geo' Douglas  
Red Oak Texas

04-031-P02 Zella Douglas —  
1715 — Grand Avenue —  
North Fort Worth —  
Texas —

04-031-P03 *[[postmark]]*  
RED OAK  
AUG  
*[[illegible]]*  
*[[/postmark]]*

04-031-P04 *[[postage]]*  
UNITED STATES  
TWO CENTS  
*[[/postage]]*

**Editorial note.** A further envelope image. Similar to scan 25, but reproduced separately here as supplied. Day and year of the postmark are unclear.

### Scan 032 04-032

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 32

04-032-P01 Wednesday Eve

04-032-P02 Dear Zella, Just got your letter. I staid with Clarence & Kate Sunday night and saw you in the car window Monday morning as you passed.

04-032-P03 Came on home in the evening, and today went back for the laundry and the young lady. Had a puncture coming home and got mighty hot and dirty fixing it. Delivered the young lady at her home and in a few hundred yards returning the same wheel went down again. Had a time. Some men came along and all of us put together could not fix it, so I drove to Rockett on the rim, and with the help of Sid Farrar soon had it righted up. Came on and spent three hours with Kate. The children surely look bad. Glenn was not well, but Kate looks much better than I expected.

**Editorial note.** Letter continues on scan 33.

### Scan 033 04-033

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 33

04-033-P01 They will have to give up that place the first of August. Will likely come to Roland's house in the pasture.

04-033-P02 The letter to you from Paris I opened to see if it should be forwarded. Find it enclosed. Will send yours to your Aunt Nannie by way of explanation.

04-033-P03 I do hope your appetite will stay with you and that the girls will see to your wants. Dont be a burden and dont overdo yourself.

04-033-P04 Dont worry about me. I boiled me two potato's and six eggs yesterday evening, and Ruth gave me a glass of plum jelly and I have plenty of bread, and I reboiled the Molasses and strained it through the new sifter. So I am prepared to get fat. Elmer Carter is very glad to get all of the Cow. Rain plenty since you left. Tell Edwina I enjoyed reading her good letter hugely.

04-033-P05 Affectionately  
G. D.

**Editorial note.** Closing continuation of scan 32. "get all of the Cow" is retained as written; the wording has not been expanded into an inferred meaning.

### Scan 034 04-034

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 34

04-034-P01 *[[deleted: Monday]] [[inserted: Tuesday]]* Morning.

04-034-P02 Dear Zella —

04-034-P03 Yours written Sunday came yesterday. I am glad you did not have a bad time last week, and hope you will do better this week. I know Ed's expenses must be enormous; but be sure you do not add any to them. Our house keepers packed up their goods Saturday, and Sunday Evening loaded them on two wagons, and Monday morning pulled out for Bartlett Texas. At Waxahachie they shipped their effects, and by now are at their destination.

04-034-P04 So my prospects for baching grows brighter from day to day. Sure I live better, and my next cook must look refined. My nieces cant understand why I persist in staying at home, and there is not much use for it except I hate for the house to be unoccupied at night. Elmer Carter has taken the Cow to his house, and there is nothing to do but gather up a very few eggs of an evening.

**Editorial note.** The weekday was corrected above the original "Monday." Continuation on scan 35.

**Scan 035 04-035**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 35

04-035-P01 The hens are on strike mostly. They mainly water just below the Feterita patch at a swamp spring, and the feterita furnishes them fine picking.

04-035-P02 Our meeting crowds are small, and the preaching not much bigger. It chafes Bro. Dunn very perceptibly, but he has a poor way of helping himself, as the job of building up a large audience is a big one. The crowds will be apt to grow later on.

04-035-P03 Word came down last night that Olaf wished to be baptized, so Bro. Duncan returned immediately to Red Oak to make preparation and Bro. Dunn and others went up after Church was over to attend to it. I have no word from them up to this writing. Dr. Stoker told the friends that apparently he had *[[deleted: only]]* only a few days to live. This is hard on Kate but not unexpected. Lucile can sit up in a rocker an hour or so each day. I will close this when I hear from them after awhile.

04-035-P04 At Kate's Tuesday Eve. Olaf is resting fairly well now. Looks bad, and very much emaciated. Plenty of friends here, which *[[inserted: makes]]* them feel that they are not neglected. Do not note any change in Lucile —

04-035-P05 Affectionately G. D.

**Editorial note.** Closing continuation of scan 34. A repeated canceled word and an insertion in the pencil postscript are recorded.

**Scan 036 04-036**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 36

04-036-P01 Thursday Morning

04-036-P02 Dear Zella,

04-036-P03 Olaf died yesterday evening at six thirty. I am just ready to start up there. Was there a couple of hours yesterday morning. They had all the attention from the outside that was needful for their comfort.

04-036-P04 Lucile is still able to sit up a little while every day.

04-036-P05 Larkin is sick with *[[deleted: bl]]* blood poisoning. Was there a couple of hours yesterday evening. To begin with a hen scratched him on the thumb some days ago, this inflamed and was very painful. That got some better and now he has a large red spot on top of his right foot with red streaks running most up to the knee, he has some fever but is not suffering much. Mrs. Wadley, the Dr's mother died yesterday evening.

**Editorial note.** Letter continues on scan 37. The partial canceled start of "blood" is recorded.

**Scan 037 04-037**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 37

04-037-P01 Red Oak

Thursday Evening — Just back from Olof's burial at the Rawlins cemetery — Many friends and sympathizers were present. Bro Dunn made a good comforting talk at the tabernacle. Twas very hot but I stood it pretty well — I cannot say what effect all of this death and funeral will have on Lucile yet — She

seems to have considerable vitality and may linger for quite awhile — Hattie Stanford is to be baptized this evening. Quite a lot of the Patrick Chapel people were down today, and quite a lot are reported coming from Oak Cliff Sunday —

04-037-P02 I hope you are doing finely this week.

04-037-P03 Affectionately G. D.

**Editorial note.** Closing continuation of scan 36. The name spelled “Olaf” on scan 36 appears as “Olof” here; the difference is retained.

## Scan 038 04-038

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 38

04-038-P01 Thursday Morning.

04-038-P02 Dear Zella,

04-038-P03 I am still Baching and doing fine. Somehow I do not expect my housekeepers any way soon.

04-038-P04 Mary Roberts sent down and got all the Fruit jars she wanted some days ago, and yesterday Evening Edna came and got seventeen for her Mother.

04-038-P05 I got some of the peaches from the tree up by the mustang vine, and yesterday I put up a gallon and a quart of preserves all by myself. I had 12 pounds of peaches, and 9 pounds sugar, began at sun up and got through by noon. I did not use a single drop of water. Have disposed of 13 dollars worth of potato's and have plenty left. Kate and children are doing as well as could be expected.

04-038-P06 Nothing new. Affectionately G. D.

**Editorial note.** The name in the salutation has a flourished initial, read here as Zella, as in adjacent letters. No date other than the weekday is supplied in this entry.

## Scan 039 04-039

Envelope | Source 04, PDF page 39

04-039-P01 Suite 1614  
100 East 42nd Street  
New York

04-039-P02 Mr. C. C. Douglas  
212 East University  
Waxahachie, Texas

04-039-P03 *[[postmark]]*  
NEW YORK N. Y.  
FEB 28  
1941  
*[/postmark]]*

04-039-P04 *[[postage]]*  
U. S. POSTAGE  
6 CENTS 6

PAID

5260 N. P. M.

[[/postage]]

**Editorial note.** Printed and typed envelope. Read after rotation. Postmark year 1941 is retained even though the collection title ends in 1939.

## Scan 040 04-040

Printed form | Source 04, PDF page 40

04-040-P01 Application # 189553

Form CL-18-Rev.

04-040-P02 THE FEDERAL LAND BANK OF HOUSTON

Division of Commissioners Loans

Houston, Texas, January 27, 1939

04-040-P03 Loan of Bruce Headrick

P. O. Red Oak, Texas

Association Ellis

04-040-P04 Refer to This Number In All Correspondence Concerning This Loan.

LOAN NO. 336394J

04-040-P05 We attach hereto remittances in connection with this loan, in the amounts and payable as hereinafter shown.

At the time you close this loan, see that the borrower understands:

That the first payment of \$7.00, for interest only and will be due April 1, 1939; That thereafter his payments will be due and payable at this office on the first of October and April each year. Note dated January 11, 1939 for 10 years.

In closing loans, please follow carefully the instructions and directions given below.

04-040-P06 COUNTY | ACRES | SEC. NO. | BLK. NO. | SURVEY OR GRANT | ABSTRACT NO.

[[blank]] | [[blank]] | [[blank]] | [[blank]] | (See FLB) | [[blank]]

04-040-P07 SECOND LIEN STATEMENT OF DISTRIBUTION OF PROCEEDS OF THIS LOAN

DEBIT | CREDIT

1. Loan fee \$ [[blank]] (Less initial deposit \$ [[blank]]) | \$ [[blank]] | \$ [[blank]]

2. Withheld Proceeds | [[blank]] | [[blank]]

3. Check No. 341819 Payable to Assn. and Bruce Headrick and Zella Douglas. | \$1000.00 | [[blank]]

4. Check No. [[blank]] Payable to Assn. and [[blank]] | \$ [[blank]] | [[blank]]

5. Check No. [[blank]] Payable to Assn. and [[blank]] | \$ [[blank]] | [[blank]]

6. Check No. [[blank]] Payable to Assn. and [[blank]] | \$ [[blank]] | [[blank]]

7. Check No. [[blank]] Payable to Assn. and [[blank]] | \$ [[blank]] | [[blank]]

8. Check No. [[blank]] Payable to Assn. and [[blank]] | \$ [[blank]] | [[blank]]

9. Check No. [[blank]] Payable to Assn. and [[blank]] | \$ [[blank]] | [[blank]]

[[blank]] | [[blank]] | \$1000.00

TOTAL LOAN | \$ [[blank]] | \$1000.00

04-040-P08 Comply with general loan closing instructions furnished you by the Federal Land Bank of Houston and the instructions contained in form letter sent to you dated January 11 1939.  
THE FOLLOWING SPECIAL INSTRUCTIONS AND REQUIREMENTS MUST BE OBSERVED IN CLOSING THIS LOAN

3. To pay balance purchase money lien.  
(See FLB)

04-040-P09 ELLIS  
WM. J. MILLS:LOW  
Thos. F. White, Attorney.  
The above is correct and hereby approved *[[blank]]*, Borrower.  
Date *[[blank]]*  
Attest: *[[blank]]*, Sec.-Treas.

**Editorial note.** Printed form with typed entries. Table columns are separated by vertical bars; empty ruled fields are marked *[[blank]]*. The loan number is close to the right edge of the scan.

## Scan 041 04-041

Printed form | Source 04, PDF page 41

04-041-P01 Application # 189553  
Form 104 Revised 5M Sets

04-041-P02 THE FEDERAL LAND BANK OF HOUSTON  
Houston, Texas, January 27, 1939

04-041-P03 Loan of Bruce Headrick  
P. O. Route 1, Red Oak, Texas  
Thru the Ellis N. F. L. A.

04-041-P04 Refer to This Number in All Correspondence Concerning This Loan.  
LOAN NO. 92466J

04-041-P05 To the SECRETARY-TREASURER of Above Association:  
We attach hereto remittances in connection with this loan, in the amounts and payable as hereinafter shown.  
At the time you close this loan, see that the member understands:  
That his first payment of \$11.03 is for interest only and will be due *[[deleted: January 20]]* *[[inserted: April 1]]* 1939; that this payment covers the interest from the date of original voucher to the beginning of the first amortization period (the interest from date of note to date of voucher having already been rebated). That thereafter his payment will be regular semi-annual amortization payments of \$66.60 each, and will be due and payable at this office on the first of April and October each year. That all payments must be made to the Secretary-Treasurer of his Association in time sufficient for remittance to reach this Bank on or before the date payment is due.  
In closing loans, please follow carefully the instructions and directions given below.  
Very truly yours, R. D. JOHNSON, Treasurer.

04-041-P06 COUNTY | ACRES | SEC. NO. | BLK. NO. | SURVEY OR GRANT | ABSTRACT NO.  
Ellis | 70 | *[[blank]]* | *[[blank]]* | A. J. Porter | 829

## 04-041-P07 STATEMENT OF DISTRIBUTION OF PROCEEDS OF THIS LOAN

18 Shares of Stock at \$5.00 per Share Deducted | \$90.00

To pay balance loan fee | \$7.00

Withheld Proceeds | \$ [[blank]]

Check No. 341818 Payable to Sec.-Treas. and Zella Douglas | \$1703.00

Check No. [[blank]] Payable to Sec.-Treas. and [[blank]] | \$ [[blank]]

Check No. [[blank]] Payable to Sec.-Treas. and [[blank]] | \$ [[blank]]

Check No. [[blank]] Payable to Sec.-Treas. and [[blank]] | \$ [[blank]]

Check No. [[blank]] Payable to Sec.-Treas. and [[blank]] | \$ [[blank]]

Check No. [[blank]] Payable to Sec.-Treas. and [[blank]] | \$ [[blank]]

[[blank]] | \$1703.00

TOTAL LOAN | \$1800.00

04-041-P08 Comply with general loan closing instructions furnished you by the Federal Land Bank of Houston and the instructions contained in form letter sent to you dated January 11 1939.

THE FOLLOWING SPECIAL INSTRUCTIONS AND REQUIREMENTS MUST BE OBSERVED IN CLOSING THIS LOAN

Enclosed Transfer and Assignment is to be executed, recorded and returned.

The total indebtedness against this security is not to exceed \$2800.00.

Furnish tax certificate covering the above described security showing that all state, county, school, special assessments and any other taxes assessed against the property have been paid to and including the year 1938.

04-041-P09 Ellis

Thos. F. White, Attorney.

WM. J. MILLS:LOW

TOTAL COST TO BORROWER IN SECURING THIS LOAN

[[ \$ com? ]]

Bank charges (application fee), \$17.00; Association charges, \$ [[blank]]; total cost, \$ [[blank]]

The above is correct and hereby approved [[blank]], Borrower.

Date [[blank]]

Attest: [[blank]], Sec.-Treas.

**Editorial note.** Printed form with typed entries and handwritten correction of the first-payment date. Blank fields are represented explicitly. The small notation near the bottom left is difficult; "\$ com" is provisional. Amount and date readings require checking against the source before financial or historical use.

## Scan 042 04-042

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 42

04-042-P01 State of Texas

County of Ellis

04-042-P02 Know all parties to whom these presents shall come that we the undersigned heirs at law to the estate of N. L. Douglas for and in consideration of the portions of Said estate to us individually and severally deeded by Mary Douglas our mother the receipt of which is hereby acknowledged do each severally and singly bind ourselves our heirs and assigns to forever quit in our behalf and in behalf of each other, all claims against all parts and parcels of said estate not received to us individually and

severally by deeds as aforesaid. In witness whereof we hereunto affix our names and acknowledge this instrument before the proper authorities

04-042-P03 This February 19 1875

Jeppe Douglas  
George Douglas  
Lizzie Douglas  
Laura Robinson  
Thos. J. Robinson  
Susanna Bell  
J. M. Bell  
J. H. Douglas  
Warren Douglas

04-042-P04 *[[separate block: acknowledgment]]*

04-042-P05 The State of Texas  
County of Ellis

04-042-P06 Before Me the undersigned authority this day Personally appeared George Douglas Lizzie Douglas and W. Douglas Thos J Robinson J. M. Bell Parties to Me well Known and acknowledged that they Executed the foregoing quit claim Deed for all the purposes and considerations therein set forth.

04-042-P07 At the Same time and Place Personally appeared Laura Robinson wife of the said Thos. J. Robinson & Susanna Bell wife of the said J. M. Bell to Me well Known who having

**Editorial note.** The quitclaim identifies Mary Douglas as “our mother” and the signatories as heirs of N. L. Douglas. This does not itself identify N. L. Douglas’s father or birthplace. The faint signatures and the first date need further scrutiny. Acknowledgment continues in the overlapping scan 43.

## Scan 043 04-043

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 43

04-043-P01 The State of Texas  
County of Ellis

04-043-P02 Before Me the undersigned authority this day Personally appeared George Douglas Lizzie Douglas and W. Douglas Thos J Robinson J. M. Bell Parties to Me well Known and acknowledged that they Executed the foregoing quit claim Deed for all the purposes and considerations therein set forth.

04-043-P03 At the Same time and Place Personally appeared Laura Robinson wife of the said Thos. J. Robinson & Susanna Bell wife of the said J. M. Bell to Me well Known who having Been examined by Me Privily and apart and out of *[[obscured: fold]]* that they Signed the Same of their own free will and accord without fear force or undue persuasion on the Part of their Said Husbands and that they desire not to retract it.

04-043-P04 To certify which I hereto set My hand and official Seal the 26th day of February A D 1875  
No 76

*[[S. M. ?]]* Hancock N P E C  
Texas Precinct No 8  
*[[seal]]*

04-043-P05 *[[separate block: further acknowledgment]]*

04-043-P06 The State of Texas  
County of *[[Rusk?]]*

04-043-P07 Personally appeared before me the undersigned authority *[[Jeppe?]]* Douglas to me well known who acknowledged to me that he signed sealed and delivered the foregoing quit claim deed for the purposes and intentions within Set forth & Expressed and that he does not wish to retract the Same or any Part thereof.

04-043-P08 In testimony whereof I hereto Set my and affix my Official Seal at Office in *[[illegible]]* on the 9th day *[[lost: reproduced portion ends]]*

**Editorial note.** Overlapping reproduction of the acknowledgment begun on scan 42. The lower acknowledgment continues on scan 44. Portions hidden by the fold have not been silently supplied from that other image.

## Scan 044 04-044

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 44

04-044-P01 *[[lost: reproduced portion begins mid-sentence]]* to me well known *[[lost: top edge]]*  
Been examined by Me Privily and apart and out of hearing of their said Husbands they the said Laura Robinson and Susanna Bell acknowledged that they Signed the Same of their own free will and accord without fear force or undue persuasion on the Part of their said Husbands and that they desire not to retract it.

04-044-P02 To certify which I hereto Set My hand and official Seal the 26th day of February A D 1875  
No 76  
*[[S. M.?]]* Hancock N P E C  
Texas Precinct No 8

04-044-P03 *[[separate block]]*

04-044-P04 The State of Texas  
County *[[Rusk?]]*

04-044-P05 Personally appeared before me the undersigned authority *[[Jeppe?]]* Douglas to me well known who acknowledged to me that he signed sealed and delivered the foregoing quit claim deed for the purposes and intentions within Set forth & Expressed and that he does not wish to retract the Same or any Part thereof.

04-044-P06 In testimony whereof I hereto Set my and affix my Official Seal at Office in *[[illegible]]* on the 9th *[[lost: torn edge]]*  
March A. D. 1875.

04-044-P07 *[[illegible signature]]*  
Notary Public  
In *[[illegible]]* County  
State of Texas

**Editorial note.** Further overlapping scan of the acknowledgments. This image reveals wording concealed by the fold on scan 43. The lower county, place, and notary's name remain unresolved.

## Scan 045 04-045

Recording endorsements | Source 04, PDF page 45

04-045-P01 *[[separate block: filing endorsement]]*

1st

Geo Douglas et al

To

Mary Douglas

Deed

Filed for Record at 10½ oclock am

Aug 21st 1875

J M Phillips

Cl D C

Book O Page 2

85 — *[[Paid?]]*

04-045-P02 *[[separate block: recording certificate]]*

The State of Texas.

COUNTY OF ELLIS.

04-045-P03 I, J. M. PHILLIPS, Clerk of the District Court in and for said County, do hereby certify that the foregoing instrument in writing was filed in my office for record at 10½ o'clock A. M., Aug the 21st, A. D. 1875, and by me, on this the 23 day of Aug, A. D. 1875, at 9 o'clock A M., duly recorded in Deed Record O of said County, on pages 2 & 3 —

04-045-P04 To certify which, witness my official seal and signature, at office in Waxahachie, on this the day and date last above written.

04-045-P05 J M Phillips

Clerk District Court Ellis County Texas.

Per H. C. Wise Deputy.

**Editorial note.** The upper filing panel is rotated relative to the printed certificate. The manuscript book letter is read as O, not the numeral zero.

## Scan 046 04-046

Typescript | Source 04, PDF page 46

04-046-P01 Field Notes for Bruce Hedrick.

04-046-P02 Being 70.0 acres of the A.J. Porter Survey, Abst. No. 829, in Ellis County, Texas, described as follows:

04-046-P03 Beginning at an iron stake at the N.W. corner of the Miss Zella Douglas property, said point being on the South line of the Geo. Douglas 80 acre tract, described in Vol. Z, Page 58 of the Deed Records of said County, and the N.E. corner of the J.H. Hedrick 20 acres described in Vol. 179, Page 362 of said Deed Records.

04-046-P04 Thence N. 60 E., with the South line of said Douglas 80 acres, 625 vrs. to a stake.

04-046-P05 Thence S. 30 E., 587 vrs. to the center of Brushy Creek.

04-046-P06 Thence up said Creek with the center of its channel as follows;  
 S. 61-3/4 W., 55 vrs.; S. 13-1/4 W., 78 vrs.; S. 49-3/4 W., 99 vrs.;  
 S. 73-3/4 W., 25 vrs.; N. 48 W., 65-5/10 vrs.; S. 64-3/4 W., 61-5/10 vrs.;  
 S. 73-3/4 W., 63 vrs.; S. 29 W., 91 vrs.; S. 14 W., 54-5/10 vrs.;  
 S. 18-3/4 E., 60-5/10 vrs.; S. 51 W., 42 vrs.; S. 87-3/4 W., 93 vrs. to the West line of said Zella Douglas property.

04-046-P07 Thence N. 30 W., with the West line of said property, 680 vrs. to the beginning.

**Editorial note.** Survey bearings, fractions, and distances are reproduced as typed, without converting units or reconciling them to other deeds.

## Scan 047 04-047

Envelope fragment | Source 04, PDF page 47

04-047-P01 Sept 3 —  
 Union City

04-047-P02 Zella.

**Editorial note.** Most of the envelope reverse is blank; a large portion is torn away.

## Scan 048 04-048

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 48

04-048-P01 Union City Sept 3 — 1923

04-048-P02 My Dear Child —

04-048-P03 Your very brown letter just to hand. With the aid of a magnifying glass I managed to read it mostly. Please use ink, or rough paper that a pencil will make a mark on.

04-048-P04 I want a hundred dollars for the Ford. No trade. That hundred would pay your trip here if you should come.

04-048-P05 Sell the young cattle as it wont pay to winter them. Put up feed for one cow only. Pay the taxes, and have Ligon to attend to note due the

**Editorial note.** Letter begins here and continues on scans 49–51. Read after rotation. Year reads 1923.

## Scan 049 04-049

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 49

04-049-P01 2

04-049-P02 Waxahachie Bank, due the Eleventh of September.

04-049-P03 Look over my letters and go by instructions.

04-049-P04 As to when I will get home I don't know; but from present prospects I will say not before the first of November. This last proposition if any difference is worse than the first —

04-049-P05 A large lump came out through my cheek, and there is another to follow not so large.

04-049-P06 I see no chance for the hole to heal this side of November. I am not suffering much now, but it has been very bad.

04-049-P07 I get about eighteen

**Editorial note.** Original page number 2 retained. The account is the writer's own description; no retrospective diagnosis is added.

## Scan 050 04-050

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 50

04-050-P01 3

04-050-P02 hours of ease out of the twenty four. The thing I fear is that more Metastases may set up —

04-050-P03 The radium had scattered the trouble into my *[[deleted: cheek]]* cheek, and in such small particles that it will take time for them to develope.

04-050-P04 So it is impossible to say yet awhile, whether or not all of them have been caught up with.

04-050-P05 This last will be four that has been caught up with; and I would be glad to know that it was the last — I specified all the clothing I want, dont send any more.

**Editorial note.** Original page number 3 retained. The deleted word is overwritten; read here as an abandoned first attempt at “cheek.”

## Scan 051 04-051

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 51

04-051-P01 4

04-051-P02 Dont send them in a suit case. Roll up tight and sew a cloth around them — Wrap in brown paper, send by parcels post insured. That is the cheapest and the best.

04-051-P03 Please read my letters and go by instructions.

04-051-P04 Get a close estimate of the crop. You may have to come out here; and it will take a hundred dollars to cover the trip; and I want all debts at home paid so as to know how best to do.

04-051-P05 A trip out here will wear you out, get on your nerves, and I do not know that you would be able to stand it. But be ready.

**Editorial note.** Original page number 4. Continues the letter beginning on scan 48.

## Scan 052 04-052

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 52

04-052-P01 5

04-052-P02 Should you have to come bring warm clothing as this is cooler than Texas. Half moon pies well cooked, sandwiches like you provided for me, make a splendid traveling ration, and a tin cup for water is indispensable.

04-052-P03 No! I cant come back by Nashville. I would not risk the altitude over the Cumberland Mountains. I am glad Anna stopped to see you. I hope among you that you will make her visit pleasant. My appetite stays good. Sleep well.

04-052-P04 Affectionately Papa

**Editorial note.** Original page number 5. Signed closing, followed by additional writing on scans 53–54.

### Scan 053 04-053

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 53

04-053-P01 I would love for you to be here, for I get very blue and lonesome at times, and you are all I have that is best to live for. With the number of my years I cant stay here long, so your company is that much more precious. I may survive this trouble and may not. At all events my physical strength will be greatly weakened, and for this reason I wanted the car sold, as my car cranking days are over.

**Editorial note.** Additional page associated with the September 3 letter. No page number is visible.

### Scan 054 04-054

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 54

04-054-P01 I only ask that you get the business in good shape, know how much money is on hand, and how much more is likely to come in, and what has to be met; so if we deem it expedient you can make me a visit. You would not get much out of these people, they are not your sort.

04-054-P02 Allie leaves tomorrow for *[[illegible]]* to run a Dormitory. I am staying with Dr Bird. Papa.

**Editorial note.** Additional closing page. The destination after “for” is unclear in the scan and has not been inferred.

### Scan 055 04-055

Envelope | Source 04, PDF page 55

04-055-P01 Zella Douglas

Red Oak —

Texas —

04-055-P02 *[[postmark]]*

UNION CITY

SEP 7

12:30 AM

CA.

1923

*[[/postmark]]*

04-055-P03 *[[postage]]*

UNITED STATES POSTAGE

2 CENTS 2

*[[/postage]]*

**Editorial note.** Envelope read after rotation. The time is small and may require confirmation from a higher resolution source.

**Scan 056 04-056**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 56

04-056-P01 Thursday 6.

04-056-P02 Dear Child,

04-056-P03 Your letter of Monday came this morning. Glad you wrote with ink, so easy to read. Glad you and Anna are having a good time. I note you went to Waxa Monday. That will learn you to watch out for holidays. Your package came all right, I took out what I wanted, what I wrote you to send, and sent the rest back to you. The old suit you did not send, I gave Mrs Henderson the suit case.

**Editorial note.** Letter continues on scan 57. The first sentence refers to the legibility of a letter received; "That will learn you" is retained.

**Scan 057 04-057**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 57

04-057-P01 Dr. says my trouble is doing fine, and of course he knows better than I do. I am feeling first rate today. I had the blues when I wrote you Monday, which you are reading today.

04-057-P02 No, I do not want to put up any Beef, much less can any. Too much risk of poisoning.

04-057-P03 If Ernest wants to kill one and peddle it out and you keep a small piece, all right; but I do not think it would pay.

**Editorial note.** Continuation of scan 56.

**Scan 058 04-058**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 58

04-058-P01 3

04-058-P02 If Bruce wants the car very much, he will get rid of his and buy, and if he does not, some one else will, as the high price of cotton will put some money in the country.

04-058-P03 Very sorry to hear of Ira's condition. That means a great deal of suffering any way it goes. I am glad that Ernest's cotton is turning out so well. There must be some mistake about it. Get an estimate on the whole crop as soon as you can.

**Editorial note.** Original page number 3.

**Scan 059 04-059**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 59

04-059-P01 4

04-059-P02 My appetite holds up, and I sleep well, and tomorrow I expect to help the Dr. make cider. Apples are falling off very badly from some cause, and the "pick ups," fallen apples, makes about two gallons of cider to the bushel. The quality is inferior but it is better than none. Good apples here sell from a dollar to a dollar and a half per bushel. Cider fifty cents to a dollar per gallon. Pears 1.00 to 1.50 per bushel.

**Editorial note.** Original page number 4. Prices are copied as expressed, including the final figures.

### Scan 060 04-060

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 60

04-060-P01 5

04-060-P02 Keep up with your business. If I keep on improving and feeling better, there will be no use in your spending money on a trip here. It would wear you out and I would have to wait on you for a week. Dr. has five patients now. Well this is enough for this time.

04-060-P03 Affectionately Papa.

**Editorial note.** Original page number 5. Closing of the letter beginning on scan 56.

### Scan 061 04-061

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 61

04-061-P01 Friday, 9. A. M.

04-061-P02 The last plug is removed, and future treatments not needed unless more Metastasis sets up. No indications of that this morning.

04-061-P03 It will take a long time to heal the hole in my cheek made by the cancer coming out, but the process will not be painful, only tedious.

04-061-P04 Practically the hurting is all over, only soreness remains; and that is disappearing. Less swelling now than

**Editorial note.** Postscript or continuation in the same series of letters. This is the writer's historical account of treatment, reproduced without endorsing its explanation.

### Scan 062 04-062

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 62

04-062-P01 when I left home, and less soreness.

04-062-P02 The lump under my chin is gradually getting less, thinner and flatter, about like a small butter bean. So I can say for you to rest easy on my account from now on; for I surely do feel hopeful this morning of a final cure.

04-062-P03 The Dr. wont let me do any work, because getting warmed up by exercise retards the healing process. I make my bed of a morning, wash my

**Editorial note.** Continues scan 61.

### Scan 063 04-063

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 63

04-063-P01 kerchiefs as often as needed, wipe the dishes for Mrs Henderson, help string beans, shuck roasting ears, and do any little odd job that comes handy.

04-063-P02 Mr. Ridley is improving right along, but with the skin all off the back of his hand it will take a long time to heal over.

04-063-P03 Mrs. Johnson is getting along very slowly. I do not know whether she will have the vitality to pull through or not. The cancer is killed I think, but her health is bad.

**Editorial note.** Continuation of scans 61–62. No signature visible on this page.

## Scan 064 04-064

Envelope | Source 04, PDF page 64

04-064-P01 Zella Douglas

Red Oak

Texas

04-064-P02 *[[postmark]]*

UNION CITY

SEP 12

12 PM

CA.

*[[illegible]]*

*[[/postmark]]*

04-064-P03 *[[postage]]*

UNITED STATES POSTAGE

2 CENTS 2

*[[/postage]]*

**Editorial note.** Envelope read after rotation. The year in the cancellation is too faint to read confidently.

## Scan 065 04-065

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 65

04-065-P01 Wednesday 11-23-

My Dear Child.

Yours of Monday just to hand and I am glad of the favorable report. Maybe we will have enough to "get by" on. The healing process is doing nicely, the only trouble is I have to keep my jaw still, and this cuts out the Eating act to two meals a day. I told the Dr. I was willing to cut it out to every two or three days if it would help matters. My general health is as good as it ever was.

**Editorial note.** The heading is transcribed without supplying a month.

## Scan 066 04-066

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 66

04-066-P01 2

Now as to the old house.

I have got to tighten up my room for this winter. I noticed last winter that the cold air came in very perceptibly through the ceiling joints. There is three ways to stop this. Ceil over the old ceiling with new lumber, paper or paint the walls.

I put it up to you to fix it, as I may not get home in time to do it before cold weather.  
The front of the house needs repainting, and it would be the quickest

### Scan 067 04-067

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 67

04-067-P01 3

and perhaps the cheapest and the best to paint.

If this is done the smell would be out by cold weather. The walls would have to have a good coat of oil first to keep the paint from peeling off. Oil, paint, and putting it on, will likely cost about fifty dollars; but you might get it done cheaper. Paper might look nicer; but you could not paper overhead with *[[inserted: out]]* ceeling under the joints, and that would make it *[[labor?]]* to prepare

### Scan 068 04-068

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 68

04-068-P01 4

Have whoever paints the front of the house, clean out the *[[deleted: gu]]* gutter in front, and this may require new screen wire to cover it again.

You will have to get Ernest to bring from the lumber *[[deleted: yard]]* yard enough lumber for the Scaffolding. Show him what you want done, and he will know what to get. All the painting on the front was done before by the long ladder pieced out at the bottom.

Do you think you can do this?

### Scan 069 04-069

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 69

04-069-P01 5

I wipe the dishes sometimes, help string the beans, shuck the roasting ears, and draw an occasional bucket of water.

The Dr. wont allow me to do any thing that would make me warm, such as pick up apples and make cider. Help is as scarce here as there, and the Dr. cant get help to pick up his apples and make cider. White folks wont work *[[inserted: or dont work]]*, and niggers are scarce. I do not know when I have seen a white man hunting work.

**Editorial note.** The last word is written at the right edge. Historical racial language is retained as documentary text.

### Scan 070 04-070

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 70

04-070-P01 6

I am sorry you missed seeing Allie, as she could have given you an insight to things here. I surely do hope she wont have a breakdown — I fear her strength will not be equal to her task.

The Dr. has six patients now and may have another next week. Mrs. Johnson is very feeble. Cancer is killed, but the after effects of Xray are almost as bad. I am hurrying to get this off so you will get it

Saturday.  
Affectionately Papa.

### Scan 071 04-071

Envelope | Source 04, PDF page 71

04-071-P01 Zella Douglas  
Red Oak —  
Texas —

04-071-P02 *[[postmark]]* UNION CITY  
AUG 30  
6 PM  
GA  
1923 *[/postmark]]*  
*[[postage]]* UNITED STATES POSTAGE  
2 CENTS 2 *[/postage]]*

### Scan 072 04-072

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 72

04-072-P01 Aug 30 - 1923 -  
My Dear Child.

I am feeling pretty good this morning. Most of the cancer came out, a little left, cant tell just how much. Dr said a few more treatments he thought would finish up the job.

The lump under my jaw is going away, seemingly getting a little less from treatment to treatment. No indications of trouble there as yet. As to when I can get to come home I cant tell, nor can the Dr tell. That depends on conditions. If no further trouble comes up, and I stay until fully healed, it may be the middle of October

### Scan 073 04-073

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 73

04-073-P01 2

I suppose you have my letter telling you what to do with the Ford, the young Cattle, and putting up feed for one cow.

Now I want you to go to Mr. Ligon, get the note on The Guaranty Trust bank of Waxahachie, due the eleventh day of September, and arrange for him to collect it on that date. Dont fail in this.

Then go to Waxahachie and go to the tax collector's office, call for my tax receipt, and pay it off by check on Red Oak; then take it Farrar and Kemble attys, and leave with them. They may want

### Scan 074 04-074

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 74

04-074-P01 3

it as evidence in the suit pending in the *[[Funds?]]* tax business.

Then tell Buord Farrar to check on Red Oak for what funds he may have to have in my case as attorney. This all being attended to write me the amount of the taxes. Write it out, dont put down figures for you cant make them with a pencil legible.

Those you put down in your letter from Dallas I do not know just what they were, had to guess, and guess work wont do in business.

### Scan 075 04-075

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 75

04-075-P01 4

Have Ernest and Van to make a careful estimate of the cotton crop in Bales. I must know how the crop is turning out and the approximate price.

As to your coming out here, of course I would be glad to have you, and be glad for you to have the trip for a change; but so far there is no need of your coming. I will be very comfortably located with Dr Bird, after Allie leaves, which will be in a few days.

Should you come it will cost at least one hundred dollars for the trip, and if I get along all right there will be *no need for it*

### Scan 076 04-076

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 76

04-076-P01 5

However you are right in having your arrangements made so as to come at once if needed. Which I most sincerely hope will not be.

Stoker made an awful charge. Did he itemize it? He must have overhauled the whole machine.

Allie is making ready to go to Gunter, take charge of a Dormitory, and put the children in school. At this particular juncture, all things considered, I think a very bad move. She has cancer, and to go away from the Dr. and be gone a year, is taking a risk too great in her case. No telling what a year may bring forth.

### Scan 077 04-077

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 77

04-077-P01 6

Plenty of rain here. Corn is green and green mostly in good roasting ear. Cotton is said to be good, also the Boll Weevil.

Days are warm; 80 to 90, nights cool, sleep under cover every night.

Duckworth has been made business manager of the A.W. He has put out a circular letter to the brethren, calling for help to print it in Texas saying he has no money and that the paper has none, and he must have help to get out the first issue. If that dont kill it dead, my guess is off.

Affectionately Papa

### Scan 078 04-078

Identifying slips | Source 04, PDF page 78

04-078-P01 *[[separate block: upper identifying slip]]*

To Mr. N. L. Douglas

from son,  
 Henry Douglas  
 Palestine, Texas  
 Sept. 8, 1851

04-078-P02 *[[separate block: lower identifying slip]]*

Letters written by  
 Henry and Ellen Douglas

## Scan 079 04-079

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 79

04-079-P01 Palestine, Sept. 8th 1851

Dear Father,

Your letter of August 16th came to hand a few days ago, and I was much gratified to hear from you all again. I have just been writing to sister Rebecca, and scolded a good deal with *[[her?]]* for none of you writing to me, but I see from your letter that the fault lay entirely with the mail, so I shall not send it. I am glad to hear of the good health of the Family, and it gives me some hopes that health may be enjoyed in *[[Burky?]]*, as well as other places. This County although reputed to be one of the healthiest in the State, has been very sickly for two months past, more so than I ever saw it in Ellis Co. I think that Old Mr Benson is nearly willing to try the *[[illegible]]* again for he has not bettered himself so far as health is concerned, by moving down here.

There has been a great many deaths in the county, & five Doctors living in this place have had their hands full of practice, tho' now it is becoming *[[margin]]* more healthy *[[/margin]]*

**Editorial note.** Heavy show-through from the reverse interferes with several readings. The place name following "enjoyed in" is unresolved.

## Scan 080 04-080

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 80

04-080-P01 My own health never was better than it has been since I have been in this place. I still get plenty of work to do. I quit working for Mr Dale about a month ago & have been picking up little jobs round ever since. Were it not so expensive to live here I could make a tolerably fair living. I am now helping *[[Hedlie?]]* a large Livery Stable, my wages are \$1,50 cts pr day, but after subtracting \$10 pr month for board & washing, the amount is considerably diminished.

There is going to be a very good opening for carpenters here this coming Winter and Spring, and I am somewhat at a loss whether to continue journeywork or turn out undertaker, I think I could get plenty to do either way.

The Christian Church at this place have resolved to build a house of worship as soon as lumber can be procured. It will be 56 ft long & 34 wide and will present a very neat appearance when finished. It has not rained here for so long that I forget when it did rain last, every thing is very much parched up. Corn crops are tolerably good, but Cotton will not make more than a half crop

**Editorial note.** The surname before "a large Livery Stable" is uncertain. Show-through is visible throughout.

**Scan 081 04-081**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 81

04-081-P01 I was at Mr Mallards house a time ago, he says he is bound for old Rutherford as soon as he can get off, he and his wife have both been very sick, and he says that he cant stand the climate. He is well pleased with the country in other respects *[[illegible]]* and says if he was to stay in Texas he would move up to your country, but his wife is very much dissatisfied and cant hear to nothing else but going back to Tenn.

I believe I have written all that can interest you. Nothing gratified me more than to hear of Susannahs *[[illegible]]* the Truth, may she hold out faithful to the end is my sincere prayer. O that all the Family that have arrived at the years of discretion were gathered into the fold of Christ. I long to see you all and it may be that I will visit you between this & Christmas. I send my love to mother brothers & sisters. My respects to the neighbors & friends generally, it is too *[[tedious?]]* to mention all the names. Write to me one and all of you, and tell me all about every thing. Nothing more at present from  
Your affectionate Son.

Henry Douglas

**Editorial note.** A fold and heavy show-through obscure portions of this page, especially the clause about Susannah.

**Scan 082 04-082**

Identifying slip | Source 04, PDF page 82

04-082-P01 To Sister Lizzie Douglas  
from  
Ellen Douglas  
Jan. 12, 1862

**Scan 083 04-083**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 83

04-083-P01 Jan. 12 1862

Dear Sister Lizzie

I received your letter last week. Beck was here and we had the pleasure of reading it together it had been sometime since we had herd from you. we looked for some of you up Christmas. I had plenty of cake and pies at my cabin Christmas day and a big Egg nog. I envited some of the near neighbors to come and dine with me. and about ten oclock I looked out and saw 14 young men and girls riged out comeing I did not know that they were comeing so you see they stormed me. you may depend the youngsters about here had a lively time of it all the week after which most all the young men left for the war. I wish you and Laura had been here. I have not been any where since christmas week for I have been sick ever since was not well for a week before I am chilling now and have the old *[[razzle?]]* as heath calls it. *[[Gaskin?]]* had a chill last week and now has very sore eyes he is walking and is as pretty as any bodys boy he can talk now as good as Angus. Maggie is growing fast and will be another Sister Fleming

**Editorial note.** Personal names and the colloquial expression before “as heath calls it” should be checked against the original.

**Scan 084 04-084**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 84

04-084-P01 her health is good and she is quite hardy but she is lean not as heavy as my man Angus is as fat as a pig and is as full of fight and mischief as he can be Beck has not been very well, she stayed all week with me went home on friday. Warren had gone to deer creek to see about moveing her there as he is going to the war as soon as she is confined they will not break up housekeeping until after that, she is expecting about the 5 to the 11 of Feb. I am wrighting this part to Mother not you as I know she would like to know Warren tryed to get some of her sisters to come home with him and stay a while with her but they could not leave home from some cause or other I dont know of any body she will get to stay with her I told her I would come and stay if she could get no one else we are still in Sams cabin I expect I will remain here some time yet as there is no sign of any thing being done to the other Tell Sue I am glad to hear of her hopes being realized that is her house comenced I wish mine was on the way, but if I can get to be a neighbour to her, I dont care so much if I do have to stay in Sams cabin but when beck goes away I dont know what

**Scan 085 04-085**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 85

04-085-P01 I will do up on the *[[illegible]]* and no body very near unless some body comes and lives in their house. Well I believe I have told you about all tell Laura the last time I saw Amanda Berry she asked about her and said she must write to her Lizzie West was here not long ago she says write to her I believe they both claim a letter from her. and she must be sure and write to me is sue ever coming or any of you I recon you will all come now to see Warren before he goes off he will leave as soon as beck is able for him to move her to her fathers. *[[you must as come?]]* and all write when you can My love to Father and Mother also Sue and Boys  
as ever your affectionate Sister  
Ellen Douglas

**Editorial note.** The opening geographical phrase and wording before “and all write” remain unresolved.

**Scan 086 04-086**

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 86

04-086-P01 *[[separate block: note to Father]]*

Dear Father,

I started yesterday to Brushy to see if I could secure the Land *[[illegible]]* you, but failed to get the certificate him as I expected

I suppose Ellen & Beck have written all the news. Warren will join the Army soon. I do not know when I can come down. We are looking for some of you up before Warren starts

Buchanan Jany 15th 1862 H. Douglas

04-086-P02 *[[separate block: short note]]*

Warren is likely to get off in Feb — does not know what Co he will join yet

04-086-P03 *[[separate block: inverted note]]*

We have not yet got the fence up around the field but will soon. Wheat needs rain very much. I sent *[[752?]]* lbs wool to Shriveport it netted 26 cts

**Editorial note.** The three differently oriented blocks are transcribed separately. The sentence about the land certificate is partly obscured and its syntax remains unresolved. The wool weight is tentative.

## Scan 087 04-087

Identifying slip | Source 04, PDF page 87

04-087-P01 To Sister Lizzie  
(possibly while in California)  
from Henry Douglas  
Red Oak, Texas  
Sept. 6, 1892

## Scan 088 04-088

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 88

04-088-P01 Red Oak Tex Sept 6 1892

Dear Sister Lizzie. The reason why I have delayed so long in answering your letter is not indifference or want of affection for a dear absent sister, but rather the dazing effects of some of the contents of yours. I thought silence much easier & more prudent than to say things that, to say the least, might do no good. I do not now wish to say anything only to regret, nay lament such a condition of irreligion as portrayed in your letter Surely California & Sodom & Gomorrah are not unlike  
A day in the courts of the Lord is surely worth a thousand in such a place & I surely would make haste to get out, were I there, lest I too might forget God. "Be ye also

## Scan 089 04-089

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 89

04-089-P01 ready for the Son of man cometh in an hour when ye think not" is an injunction not to be forgotten, (the wicked *[[deleted: God]]* may forget) & I know of nothing so calculated to make us forget as the love of money or the worship of Mammon We have it here. It causes Christians to absent themselves from the house of the Lord, it weakens faith; it dulls the conscience & makes us slothful in that patient continuance in well doing by which we are to inherit the promises. We have just had a good meeting at Liberty conducted by Bros Cole & Graves  
You will rejoice with me that Clarence & Kate obeyed the gospel. They will be 14 the 8th inst & I trust when the Lord comes to make up his jewels they will be of

**Editorial note.** The short canceled word in the parenthesis is read as "God"; the resulting wording is retained without repair.

## Scan 090 04-090

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 90

04-090-P01 the number. Also your son, *[[Or. Otis Maynard?]]* Lee *[[Weatherford?]]* Robbie *[[Sullivan?]]* Jesse Graves & Mrs *[[Bur Pratts?]]* & others unknown to you I wish you could have been with us at the

meeting hope when we have our next you will be here. We are having nice weather & are gathering corn which is good Our Wheat & Oats were fine & Cotton a good average Many are picking & the gin whistles are beginning to sound If we could get fair prices we would be prospering. Mr Ward has a good crop for you I think he is a good renter

Henry Allen is going to move to Hood County near Acton & Sam *[[Strand?]]* has rented Mrs Bells place Mrs *[[Thuston?]]* has rented Dr Duffs & her son in law *[[Surren?]]* Henry Orrs place

**Editorial note.** The opening list of names lacks clear separators; "Or." and several surnames remain open to revision. "son in law" and the following names are retained without supplying relationships or punctuation.

## Scan 091 04-091

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 91

04-091-P01 Jodie is in bad health as usual & started yesterday to Erath Co. Greer Co failed on crops this year, & I don't know that he will go back there *[[illegible]]* Billy Davis fell off his wagon *[[illegible]]* *[[near?]]* *[[Palmer?]]* about 10 days ago. We have had a very healthy year so far, in fact very exceptionally so

Give my love to Tom & Laura & family & also to John & Ann *[[illegible]]* I would like to see them all but apprehend the privilege never *[[illegible]]* as the little *[[illegible]]* is beginning to *[[illegible]]* days are growing short. Write me on receipt of this saying when we may expect you home Sue will probably teach in Brushy this winter & I will send Kate to her

Give to Mr & Mrs Barton

Your brother Henry

**Editorial note.** Dark stains and folds obscure several clauses, including the accident report and the sentence about seeing the family. No cause of death or relationship is supplied where it cannot be read.

## Scan 092 04-092

Identifying slip | Source 04, PDF page 92

04-092-P01 To Mrs Mary (N. L.)

Douglas

From Henry Douglas.

Palestine, Tex

Dec. 30, 1853

**Editorial note.** The identifying slip reads December 30; the manuscript heading on scan page 93 reads December 3d.

## Scan 093 04-093

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 93

04-093-P01 Palestine Dec. 3d 1853

Dear Mother

Time passes rapidly away, & tonight I find myself writing to you instead of being on my road home, as I had wished I often think that it is not worth while to make anything like definite calculations for the future; as I fail, in them so often. The time of my going home seems to be so uncertain that I shall make no promises about it this time. The principal reason of my delay is, that I have, incurred more expences

than I anticipated, & shall have to work longer in consequence. I hoped to see Warren, down here last week, but was disappointed I had however the pleasure of meeting with David Gaslin, at Bonners ferry on Trinity, last monday evening & also on Tuesday morning. I learned from him some of the particulars about home, & amongst the rest, that Jepse & Warren had gone out on

**Editorial note.** The date is read as “3d,” not the “30” on the preceding identifying slip. The given name near the end appears “Jepse” and is retained as read.

## Scan 094 04-094

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 94

04-094-P01 Brazos. I am very much behind the times, with regard to your plans & prospects up at home; none of you seem to write on that subject, to any definite extent. True, Warren has been writing a little about his trip to the Brazos, but only casually alluded to his second trip in his last letter; & I suppose that had I gone home now I should have had the pleasure of not seeing him or Jepse either

Now when I do come, I would like to find them both at home; so you must write immediately & let me know when they are coming back

I believe this is all in the way of directions &c, at present, so I must try & think of some news to write Our meeting closed last monday night & was I think quite profitable & interesting. Owing to the cold, bad weather the representation of the neighboring Churches was not so full as we expected The Co-operation will, I think be quite effective; about 450 dols were subscribed for evangelizing purposes, & I

## Scan 095 04-095

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 95

04-095-P01 think, with a little exertion, the amount can be doubled. A committee of 5 managers, was appointed, to employ an evangelist & conduct other business of the co-operation; & we hope that great good will be accomplished, the ensuing year

Although several preachers were confidently expected to attend the meeting, yet none of them came, & Bro. Kendrick had all the preaching to do. There were *[[6?]]* baptized & one other added to the Church 2 of them were little boys, one, Addison, son of Bro Clark aged about 12 years the other Albert, Bro. K's oldest son about 10 years old. They seemed fully to understand (& I have no doubt did) what they were doing. It was a beautiful & interesting scene to see children, young & comparatively innocent, pressing into the Kingdom, & thus consecrating their lives to the Redeemer Whilst others, old & gray, could sit unmoved, under the appeals of the Gospel, nor be persuaded to devote the little remainder of their 3 score & ten, to the only Cause worth living for, & the only one that promises aught for the future

**Editorial note.** The baptism count is blotted. Fragments of another sheet visible behind the right edge are not a continuous readable passage.

## Scan 096 04-096

Manuscript | Source 04, PDF page 96

04-096-P01 I suppose I might add, that there is a good deal of sickness in the country, & I can hear of a death occasionally. My own health is excellent though. My paper is about full & I must close

04-096-P02 I now think it probable that I will be at home about Christmas or early in Jany  
My love to all,

Yours affectionately  
Henry Douglas

04-096-P03 *[[separate block: address panel and endorsements]]*

Mrs Mary Douglas  
Red Oak Texas  
3

Mrs Mary Douglas,  
Red Oak,  
Texas.

Mrs Mary Douglas  
Mr Henry Douglas

*[[illegible: fragment near seal]]*

*[[postmark]] [[illegible]] [[/postmark]]*

**Editorial note.** The continuation and closing are followed by the separately oriented address panel. The postmark is not sufficiently legible for a reliable date.